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Report: Week 2

Week 1-2 goals (per proposal):

- Data cleaning and organization for closed institutions
- Imputations
- Statistical analyses of data
- Literature review

Accomplishments

Literature Review:

- Most of literature review was completed in Week 1. I still added some sources. As mentioned in earlier reports, this is going to be an ongoing process till the end of the project.
- I reached out and got an unrelated dataset from ACE, that will be useful for citing data in the paper.
- In the process of cleaning the data, I came across some very good information about why these individual campuses closed, this is usually in news articles about them. For example, one of the campuses was rated worst for LGBT students 1 year before closure. I want to collect these sources, and have them in the sources.

Data Cleaning:

[in order of completion]

- Explored Grawe's work further, and identified important variables to look at.
- I started with cleaning the data to use them for modeling. Little stuff like spellings, uniform naming conventions, removing unnecessary variables.
- A lot of the data is missing, so I researched the colleges and filled in some of the variables.
- I contacted ACE, which is responsible for the Carnegie classifications, they were able to help out and share some of the data we were missing.
- When I was done, I made some dummy variables that will be useful for statistical analyses later on.
- After the dataset was complete I started interpolating and extrapolating the missing values in the endowment data, This was quite a process and took most of the time, since I had to use a method that actually made sense.

Statistical Analysis

- As I am writing this right now, I have not yet started with statistical analysis, but I'm hoping to finish some work before Monday.